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GAZETTEER OF POST-SOVIET SETTLEMENTS AND POPULATION HISTORIES

Urban Population Trajectories Across Belarus, Ukraine and the Russian Federation

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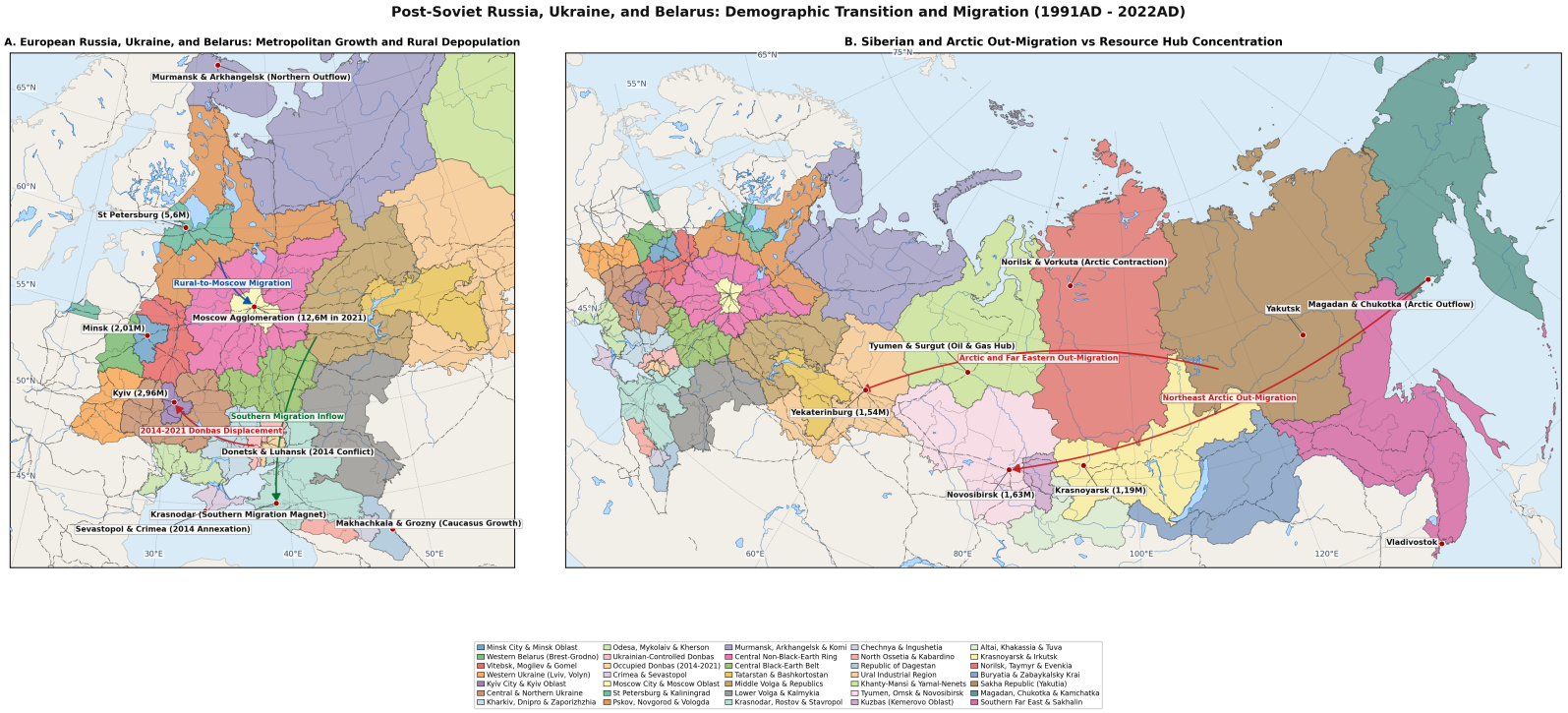


Figure 1. Distribution of the 234 catalogued urban settlements across the 35 demographic regions of Belarus, Ukraine and the Russian Federation, showing metropolitan growth poles and northern contraction zones between 1991 and 2021.

Abstract

Between the dissolution of the Soviet Union in December 1991 and the eve of the full-scale Russo-Ukrainian war in late 2021, the total population across Belarus, Ukraine and the Russian Federation declined by 14,18M (-6,7%), falling from 212,26M to 198,08M. Beneath this overall contraction, however, the urban hierarchy of the post-Soviet space underwent a marked spatial polarisation. Across the 234 major towns and cities catalogued in this gazetteer, the combined urban population rose by 6% from 91,07M in 1991 to 96,49M in 2021 as migrants moved from shrinking rural districts, mono-industrial towns and high-latitude settlements toward metropolitan, sunbelt and hydrocarbon growth poles.

This gazetteer traces the population histories of those 234 settlements across the 35 demographic regions of Belarus (Regions 1-3), Ukraine (Regions 4-11) and the Russian Federation (Regions 12-35) at five benchmark dates: 1991, 2002, 2010, 2014 and 2021. The regional tables contrast the rapid expansion of

Moscow, Saint Petersburg, Krasnodar, Makhachkala, Surgut, Tyumen, Kyiv and Minsk against the contraction of Arctic mining towns in Chukotka, Magadan, Norilsk and Vorkuta, coal-basin centres in the Kuzbass and the war-torn cities of Chechnya and the Donbas.

Methodology

This gazetteer covers 234 urban settlements across the 35 regions of Belarus (Regions 1-3), Ukraine within its 1991 borders (Regions 4-11, separating Government-Controlled Donbas in Region 9, Pre-2022 Occupied Donbas in Region 10 and Crimea and Sevastopol in Region 11) and the Russian Federation (Regions 12-35, including the North Caucasus in Regions 22-24 and Siberia and the Far East in Regions 26-35). Each regional table gives the settlement name, historical or alternative toponyms, coordinates and population estimates for 1991, 2002, 2010, 2014 and 2021.

Population figures draw on the 1999, 2009 and 2019 censuses of Belarus [1][2][3], the 2001 Ukrainian census, annual Ukrstat municipal series and the 2019 Electronic Population Assessment [4][5][6], and the 2002, 2010 and 2021 Russian censuses [7][8][9]. For northern settlements abandoned during the post-Soviet exodus, such as the Kolyma coal-mining town of Kadykchan in Region 34 (10,3k in 1991 and 875 in 2002), figures are given up to the last inhabited benchmark before closure.

Results

Minsk Metropolitan Region

Sustained migration into the Belarusian capital lifted the population of Minsk City and Minsk Oblast (Region 1) from 3,4M in 1991 to 3,48M in 2021 (+2,4%), with Minsk itself passing the two-million mark while surrounding industrial towns held steady (Table 1) [3].

Settlement	Other Names	Coords	1991	2002	2010	2014	2021	Change
Minsk	Mensk; Miensk	53,9, 27,56 (Belarus)	1,63M	1,73M	1,84M	1,92M	2,01M	+23%
Borisov	Barysaw; Barysau	54,23, 28,5 (Belarus)	147k	150k	147k	145k	136k	-7,5%
Soligorsk	Salihorsk	52,79, 27,54 (Belarus)	95k	101k	102k	105k	100k	+5,3%
Molodechno	Maladzyechna	54,32, 26,85 (Belarus)	92k	97k	94k	94k	90k	-2,2%

Table 1. Population of Minsk and principal towns in Minsk Oblast (Region 1), 1991-2021.

Western Belarus

Across Brest and Grodno oblasts (Region 2), overall population declined by -11,9% from 2,68M in 1991 to 2,36M in 2021, although the regional capitals of Grodno and Brest continued to grow through rural-to-urban migration (Table 2) [3].

Settlement	Other Names	Coords	1991	2002	2010	2014	2021	Change
Grodno	Hrodna; Gardinas	53,67, 23,81 (Belarus)	284k	310k	328k	356k	357k	+25,7%
Brest	Brest-Litovsk; Berastse	52,1, 23,73 (Belarus)	269k	294k	310k	331k	340k	+26,4%
Baranovichi	Baranavichy	53,13, 26,01 (Belarus)	165k	168k	168k	178k	173k	+4,8%
Pinsk	Pinau; Polesia Capital	52,12, 26,1 (Belarus)	122k	130k	130k	136k	125k	+2,5%
Lida	Lyda	53,88, 25,3 (Belarus)	93k	99k	98k	100k	103k	+10,8%

Table 2. Urban populations in Brest and Grodno oblasts (Region 2), 1991-2021.

Eastern and Southeastern Belarus

Post-Chernobyl resettlement in Gomel and Mogilev and severe rural ageing in Vitebsk reduced the population of Eastern and Southeastern Belarus (Region 3) by -20,6%, from 4,17M in 1991 to 3,31M in 2021 (Table 3) [3].

Settlement	Other Names	Coords	1991	2002	2010	2014	2021	Change
Gomel	Homyel; Homel	52,43, 30,98 (Belarus)	506k	481k	484k	512k	504k	-0,4%
Mogilev	Mahilyow; Mahiliou	53,9, 30,33 (Belarus)	363k	361k	358k	371k	355k	-2,2%
Vitebsk	Vitsebsk; Viciebsk	55,19, 30,2 (Belarus)	354k	343k	348k	363k	360k	+1,7%
Bobruisk	Babruysk; Babruisk	53,14, 29,22 (Belarus)	233k	221k	215k	218k	209k	-10,3%
Orsha	Vorsha	54,51, 30,42 (Belarus)	125k	122k	117k	116k	104k	-16,8%
Mozyr	Mazyr	52,05, 29,25 (Belarus)	103k	110k	109k	112k	105k	+1,9%
Novopolotsk	Navapolatsk	55,53, 28,64 (Belarus)	95k	105k	98k	101k	96k	+1,1%
Polotsk	Polatsk; Polotesk	55,49, 28,79 (Belarus)	78k	82k	83k	85k	80k	+2,6%
Zhlobin	Zhlobyn	52,89, 30,02 (Belarus)	59k	72k	76k	75k	77k	+30,5%

Table 3. Urban populations across Vitebsk, Mogilev and Gomel oblasts (Region 3), 1991-2021.

Western Ukraine and Transcarpathia

Higher rural fertility across Galicia, Volhynia, Bukovina and Zakarpattia (Region 4) cushioned labour emigration to the European Union, limiting regional contraction to -9,1% (from 10,25M in 1991 to 9,32M in 2021; Table 4) [5].

Settlement	Other Names	Coords	1991	2002	2010	2014	2021	Change
Lviv	Lvov; Lemberg	49,84, 24,03 (Ukraine)	798k	733k	734k	729k	717k	-10,2%
Chernivtsi	Chernovtsy; Czernowitz	48,29, 25,94 (Ukraine)	259k	241k	252k	262k	265k	+2,3%
Rivne	Rovno	50,62, 26,25 (Ukraine)	239k	249k	250k	250k	245k	+2,5%
Ivano-Frankivsk	Ivano-Frankovsk; Stanyslaviv	48,92, 24,71 (Ukraine)	226k	218k	224k	227k	238k	+5,3%
Ternopil	Ternopol; Tarnopol	49,55, 25,59 (Ukraine)	218k	228k	218k	217k	225k	+3,2%
Lutsk	Luchesk	50,75, 25,33 (Ukraine)	206k	209k	211k	216k	217k	+5,3%
Uzhhorod	Uzhgorod; Ungvar	48,62, 22,29 (Ukraine)	120k	117k	116k	115k	115k	-4,2%
Mukachevo	Mukacheve; Munkacs	48,44, 22,72 (Ukraine)	86k	82k	84k	85k	86k	0%
Drohobych	Drogobych	49,35, 23,5 (Ukraine)	80k	79k	78k	77k	75k	-6,2%

Table 4. Population of Lviv and regional centres in Galicia, Volhynia, Bukovina and Zakarpattia (Region 4), 1991-2021.

Kyiv and the Metropolitan Ring

Kyiv City and Kyiv Oblast (Region 5) formed the sole demographic growth pole in post-Soviet Ukraine, expanding by +4,6% from 4,58M in 1991 to 4,79M in 2021 as Kyiv and its suburban ring (Brovary, Irpin and Bucha) absorbed internal migrants and displaced residents from the east (Table 5) [5][6].

Settlement	Other Names	Coords	1991	2002	2010	2014	2021	Change
Kyiv	Kiev	50,45, 30,52 (Ukraine)	2,63M	2,61M	2,79M	2,87M	2,96M	+12,4%
Bila Tserkva	Belaya Tserkov	49,8, 30,12 (Ukraine)	204k	200k	209k	211k	208k	+2%
Brovary	Brovari	50,51, 30,79 (Ukraine)	85k	87k	96k	99k	109k	+28,2%
Irpin	Irpen	50,52, 30,24 (Ukraine)	39k	40k	41k	44k	62k	+59%

Bucha	Bucha Kyiv Oblast	50,54, 30,21 (Ukraine)	26k	28,5k	27,5k	30k	37k	+42,3%

Table 5. Population of Kyiv and its suburban commuter towns in Kyiv Oblast (Region 5), 1991-2021.

Central and Northern Ukraine

Pronounced rural ageing and out-migration across the eight oblasts of Central and Northern Ukraine (Region 6) drove regional population down by -25,5%, from 12,12M in 1991 to 9,03M in 2021 (Table 6) [5].

Settlement	Other Names	Coords	1991	2002	2010	2014	2021	Change
Vinnytsia	Vinnitsa	49,23, 28,47 (Ukraine)	381k	357k	369k	372k	371k	-2,6%
Poltava	Poltava Oblast Centre	49,59, 34,55 (Ukraine)	320k	318k	300k	296k	283k	-11,6%
Chernihiv	Chernigov	51,5, 31,29 (Ukraine)	306k	305k	297k	296k	285k	-6,9%
Cherkasy	Cherkassy	49,44, 32,06 (Ukraine)	302k	295k	287k	285k	272k	-9,9%
Zhytomyr	Zhitomir	50,25, 28,66 (Ukraine)	298k	284k	272k	271k	263k	-11,7%
Sumy	Sumi	50,91, 34,8 (Ukraine)	298k	293k	272k	269k	259k	-13,1%
Kropyvnyt-skyi	Kirovohrad; Yelisavetgrad	48,51, 32,26 (Ukraine)	278k	254k	236k	233k	222k	-20,1%
Khmelnytskyi	Khmelnitsky; Proskuriv	49,42, 26,99 (Ukraine)	245k	254k	261k	266k	274k	+11,8%
Kremenchuk	Kremenchug	49,07, 33,42 (Ukraine)	241k	234k	228k	226k	217k	-10%
Kamianets-Podilskyi	Kamenets-Podolsky	48,68, 26,59 (Ukraine)	105k	99k	103k	102k	98k	-6,7%
Konotop	Konotop Sumy Oblast	51,24, 33,2 (Ukraine)	97k	93k	90k	88k	85k	-12,4%
Shostka	Shostka Sumy Oblast	51,86, 33,47 (Ukraine)	94k	87k	80k	79k	73k	-22,3%
Uman	Human	48,75, 30,22 (Ukraine)	92k	89k	87k	86k	82k	-10,9%
Nizhyn	Nezhin	51,05, 31,89 (Ukraine)	81k	77k	74k	73k	67k	-17,3%

Table 6. Population of oblast capitals and secondary towns across Central and Northern Ukraine (Region 6), 1991-2021.

Kharkiv, Dnipro and Zaporizhzhia

Across Ukraine's Dnieper-Slobozhanshchyna industrial belt (Region 7), heavy-industrial restructuring and natural decrease reduced the regional population by -20,3% from 9,1M in 1991 to 7,25M in 2021 (Table 7) [5].

Settlement	Other Names	Coords	1991	2002	2010	2014	2021	Change
Kharkiv	Kharkov	49,99, 36,23 (Ukraine)	1,62M	1,47M	1,45M	1,45M	1,42M	-12,2%
Dnipro	Dnipropet-rovsk; Yekateri-noslav	48,46, 35,05 (Ukraine)	1,19M	1,06M	1M	993k	968k	-18,6%
Zaporizhzhia	Zaporozhye; Aleksan-drovsk	47,84, 35,14 (Ukraine)	897k	815k	780k	766k	710k	-20,8%
Kryvyi Rih	Krivoy Rog	47,91, 33,39 (Ukraine)	724k	669k	670k	652k	603k	-16,7%
Kamianske	Dniprodz-erzhynsk	48,52, 34,62 (Ukraine)	284k	256k	244k	241k	229k	-19,4%
Melitopol	Melitopol Zaporizhzhia	46,85, 35,37 (Ukraine)	176k	160k	158k	157k	150k	-14,8%
Nikopol	Nikopol Dnieper	47,57, 34,4 (Ukraine)	159k	136k	122k	117k	105k	-34%
Berdiansk	Berdyansk	46,76, 36,8 (Ukraine)	135k	122k	117k	115k	107k	-20,7%
Pavlohrad	Pavlograd	48,53, 35,87 (Ukraine)	134k	119k	111k	110k	103k	-23,1%
Lozova	Lozovaya	48,89, 36,31 (Ukraine)	73k	64k	59k	58k	54k	-26%
Izium	Izyum	49,21, 37,26 (Ukraine)	64k	56k	52k	51k	46k	-28,1%

Table 7. Urban populations in Kharkiv, Dnipropetrovsk and Zaporizhzhia oblasts (Region 7), 1991-2021.

Ukrainian Black Sea Littoral

The maritime oblasts of Odesa, Mykolaiv and Kherson (Region 8) contracted by -13,8% from 4,7M in 1991 to 4,05M in 2021, with Odesa holding near one million inhabitants while shipbuilding and port towns on the Southern Bug and lower Dnieper shrank (Table 8) [5].

Settlement	Other Names	Coords	1991	2002	2010	2014	2021	Change
Odesa	Odessa	46,48, 30,72 (Ukraine)	1,11M	1,03M	1,01M	1,02M	1,01M	-8,6%
Mykolaiv	Nikolaev	46,98, 31,99 (Ukraine)	512k	514k	501k	495k	470k	-8,2%

Kherson	Cherson	46,64, 32,62 (Ukraine)	365k	328k	304k	298k	279k	-23,6%

Table 8. Population of Odesa, Mykolaiv and Kherson on the Ukrainian Black Sea littoral (Region 8), 1991-2021.

Government-Controlled Donbas

In the Ukrainian-held districts of Donetsk and Luhansk oblasts west and north of the 2014-2021 Line of Contact (Region 9), post-Soviet coal-basin shrinkage and wartime displacement reduced the population by -39%, from 3,62M in 1991 to 2,21M in 2021 (Table 9) [5].

Settlement	Other Names	Coords	1991	2002	2010	2014	2021	Change
Mariupol	Zhdanov	47,1, 37,54 (Ukraine)	522k	492k	469k	459k	431k	-17,4%
Kramatorsk	Krama-torskaya	48,74, 37,58 (Ukraine)	199k	181k	167k	163k	150k	-24,6%
Sloviansk	Slavyansk; Tor	48,85, 37,62 (Ukraine)	136k	125k	119k	117k	106k	-22,1%
Sievierodo-netsk	Severodonetsk	48,95, 38,49 (Ukraine)	133k	120k	111k	109k	101k	-24,1%
Lysychansk	Lisichansk	48,9, 38,43 (Ukraine)	126k	115k	106k	103k	93k	-26,2%
Kostianty-nivka	Konstant-inovka	48,53, 37,7 (Ukraine)	108k	95k	80k	76k	68k	-37%
Bakhmut	Artemivsk; Artemovsk	48,6, 38 (Ukraine)	91k	83k	79k	77k	71k	-22%
Pokrovsk	Kras-noarmiisk	48,28, 37,18 (Ukraine)	73k	69k	66k	65k	60k	-17,8%

Table 9. Population of Mariupol, Kramatorsk, Sievierodonetsk and frontline towns in Government-Controlled Donbas (Region 9), 1991-2021.

Occupied Donbas

Across the occupied Donetsk-Makiivka-Horlivka and Luhansk-Alchevsk conurbations (Region 10), wartime flight after April 2014 and acute natural decrease reduced the regional total by -46,3%, from 4,6M in 1991 to 2,47M in 2021 (Table 10) [5][10].

Settlement	Other Names	Coords	1991	2002	2010	2014	2021	Change
Donetsk	Yuzovka; Stalino	48,02, 37,8 (Ukraine)	1,12M	1,02M	968k	950k	905k	-19,3%
Luhansk	Lugansk; Voroshil-ovgrad	48,57, 39,31 (Ukraine)	504k	463k	434k	424k	399k	-20,8%

Makiivka	Makeyevka; Dmitrievsk	48,05, 37,93 (Ukraine)	427k	390k	360k	352k	335k	-21,5%
Horlivka	Gorlovka	48,33, 38,09 (Ukraine)	338k	292k	263k	254k	235k	-30,5%
Alchevsk	Kommunarsk; Voroshilovsk	48,47, 38,8 (Ukraine)	126k	119k	113k	110k	105k	-16,7%
Yenakiieve	Yenakiyevo	48,23, 38,2 (Ukraine)	120k	104k	87k	81k	75k	-37,5%
Kadiivka	Stakhanov; Sergo	48,57, 38,65 (Ukraine)	112k	90k	79k	77k	72k	-35,7%

Table 10. Population of Donetsk, Luhansk and coal-basin towns in Pre-2022 Occupied Donbas (Region 10), 1991-2021.

Crimea and Sevastopol

In Crimea and Sevastopol (Region 11), the population stood at 2,44M in 2021 (-3,6% relative to 2,53M in 1991), as post-2014 military and civilian inflows from the Russian Federation lifted Sevastopol from 344k in 2014 to 548k in 2021 (Table 11) [5][9].

Settlement	Other Names	Coords	1991	2002	2010	2014	2021	Change
Sevastopol	Sebastopol; Akhtiar	44,62, 33,53 (Ukraine)	366k	342k	340k	393k	548k	+49,7%
Simferopol	Aqmescit	44,95, 34,1 (Ukraine)	353k	344k	336k	332k	341k	-3,4%
Kerch	Pantica-paeum; Kerc	45,36, 36,47 (Ukraine)	178k	158k	147k	147k	155k	-12,9%
Yevpatoria	Yevpatoriya; Kezlev	45,19, 33,37 (Ukraine)	111k	106k	107k	106k	108k	-2,7%

Table 11. Population of Sevastopol, Simferopol, Kerch and Yevpatoria in Crimea (Region 11), 1991-2021.

Moscow City and Oblast

As the primary destination of internal and international migration in the Russian Federation, Moscow City and Moscow Oblast (Region 12) expanded by +33,9% from 15,8M in 1991 to 21,15M in 2021, with rapid growth across the outer commuter ring led by Balashikha, Podolsk, Khimki and Mytishchi (Table 12) [9].

Settlement	Other Names	Coords	1991	2002	2010	2014	2021	Change
Moscow	Moskva	55,76, 37,62 (Russia)	9M	10,38M	11,5M	12,11M	13,01M	+44,5%
Podolsk	Podolsk Moscow Oblast	55,43, 37,54 (Russia)	208k	181k	188k	219k	315k	+51,4%

Lyubertsy	Lyubertsy Moscow Ring	55,68, 37,9 (Russia)	165k	157k	173k	185k	224k	+35,8%
Korolev	Kaliningrad Moscow Oblast; Naukograd	55,92, 37,85 (Russia)	160k	143k	183k	188k	228k	+42,5%
Mytishchi	Mytishchi Moscow Ring	55,91, 37,73 (Russia)	155k	160k	173k	183k	255k	+64,5%
Balashikha	Balashikha-Zheleznodorozhny	55,81, 37,96 (Russia)	138k	148k	215k	247k	521k	+277,5%
Khimki	Khimki Moscow Ring	55,9, 37,43 (Russia)	135k	141k	207k	226k	257k	+90,4%
Odintsovo	Odintsovo Moscow Ring	55,68, 37,26 (Russia)	127k	135k	139k	140k	181k	+42,5%
Krasnogorsk	Krasnogorsk Moscow Oblast	55,83, 37,33 (Russia)	91k	92k	117k	132k	188k	+106,6%
Domodedovo	Domodedovo Moscow Oblast	55,44, 37,77 (Russia)	56k	56k	96k	108k	152k	+171,4%

Table 12. Population of Moscow and its principal satellite cities in Moscow Oblast (Region 12), 1991-2021.

Saint Petersburg, Leningrad and Kaliningrad

Sustained in-migration lifted Saint Petersburg, Leningrad Oblast and the Kaliningrad exclave (Region 13) by +10,5% from 7,62M in 1991 to 8,42M in 2021, including the rapid growth of suburban Murino on the northern edge of Saint Petersburg (Table 13) [9].

Settlement	Other Names	Coords	1991	2002	2010	2014	2021	Change
Saint Petersburg	Leningrad; Sankt-Peterburg	59,93, 30,34 (Russia)	5,04M	4,66M	4,88M	5,13M	5,6M	+11,3%
Kaliningrad	Konigsberg; Koenigsberg	54,71, 20,45 (Russia)	408k	430k	432k	449k	490k	+20,1%
Murino	Murino Vsevolozhsky	60,05, 30,45 (Russia)	5,4k	5k	7k	13k	89k	+1,55k%

Table 13. Population of Saint Petersburg, Murino and Kaliningrad (Region 13), 1991-2021.

Northwestern Russia and Karelia

Severe rural ageing and out-migration toward Saint Petersburg and Moscow reduced the population of Pskov, Novgorod, Vologda and Karelia (Region 14) by -24,7%, from 3,72M in 1991 to 2,8M in 2021 (Table 14) [9].

Settlement	Other Names	Coords	1991	2002	2010	2014	2021	Change
Cherepovets	Cherepovets Metallurgical	59,13, 37,9 (Russia)	315k	312k	312k	317k	305k	-3,2%
Vologda	Vologda North	59,22, 39,89 (Russia)	289k	293k	302k	308k	314k	+8,7%
Petrozavodsk	Petroskoi; Karelia Capital	61,78, 34,35 (Russia)	271k	266k	262k	272k	235k	-13,3%
Veliky Novgorod	Novgorod	58,52, 31,27 (Russia)	234k	217k	219k	220k	224k	-4,3%
Pskov	Pleskov	57,81, 28,35 (Russia)	206k	203k	203k	207k	193k	-6,3%

Table 14. Urban populations across Pskov, Novgorod, Vologda and Karelia (Region 14), 1991-2021.

European Russian Arctic

Across Murmansk and Arkhangelsk oblasts, the Komi Republic and the Nenets Autonomous Okrug (Region 15), the post-Soviet northern outflow reduced regional population by -36,1% from 4,32M in 1991 to 2,76M in 2021, with coal-mining towns in the Pechora basin (Vorkuta and Inta) losing more than half their residents (Table 15) [9].

Settlement	Other Names	Coords	1991	2002	2010	2014	2021	Change
Murmansk	Romanov-on-Murman	68,96, 33,08 (Russia)	472k	336k	307k	299k	270k	-42,8%
Arkhangelsk	Archangel	64,54, 40,52 (Russia)	419k	356k	349k	350k	301k	-28,2%
Severodvinsk	Molotovsk	64,56, 39,83 (Russia)	251k	202k	192k	187k	157k	-37,5%
Syktyvkar	Ust-Sysolsk; Komi Capital	61,67, 50,84 (Russia)	236k	230k	235k	242k	221k	-6,4%
Vorkuta	Vorkutinskoe Koltso	67,5, 64,05 (Russia)	116k	85k	71k	62k	57k	-50,9%
Ukhta	Chibyu; Komi Oil-Gas Centre	63,57, 53,68 (Russia)	113k	103k	100k	99k	80k	-29,2%

Apatity	Apatity Kola Peninsula	67,56, 33,4 (Russia)	88k	64k	59k	57k	50k	-43,2%
Inta	Inta Pechora Coal Basin	66,03, 60,17 (Russia)	60k	41k	32k	28k	20k	-66,7%

Table 15. Population of Murmansk, Arkhangelsk, Vorkuta and northern centres in the European Russian Arctic (Region 15), 1991-2021.

Central Non-Black-Earth Region

In the eleven oblasts surrounding the Moscow region (Region 16), high mortality and youth out-migration to the capital reduced the regional total by -21,1% from 12,35M in 1991 to 9,75M in 2021, accompanied by steady contraction in older textile and engineering centres such as Ivanovo, Tula and Rybinsk (Table 16) [9].

Settlement	Other Names	Coords	1991	2002	2010	2014	2021	Change
Yaroslavl	Yaroslavl Upper Volga	57,63, 39,88 (Russia)	636k	613k	592k	602k	577k	-9,3%
Tula	Tula Arms Core	54,19, 37,62 (Russia)	541k	481k	501k	491k	473k	-12,6%
Ryazan	Pereyaslavl-Ryazansky	54,63, 39,74 (Russia)	525k	522k	525k	530k	529k	+0,8%
Ivanovo	Ivanovo-Voznesensk	57, 40,97 (Russia)	482k	432k	408k	409k	362k	-24,9%
Bryansk	Debryansk	53,24, 34,36 (Russia)	456k	432k	416k	408k	379k	-16,9%
Tver	Kalinin	56,86, 35,92 (Russia)	455k	409k	404k	411k	416k	-8,6%
Vladimir	Vladimir-na-Klyazme	56,13, 40,41 (Russia)	353k	316k	345k	350k	350k	-0,8%
Smolensk	Smolensk Upper Dnieper	54,78, 32,04 (Russia)	346k	325k	327k	331k	317k	-8,4%
Kaluga	Kaluga Oka	54,53, 36,28 (Russia)	345k	335k	325k	334k	337k	-2,3%
Kostroma	Kostroma Upper Volga	57,77, 40,93 (Russia)	281k	279k	269k	273k	267k	-5%
Rybinsk	Andropov; Shcherbakov	58,05, 38,86 (Russia)	252k	223k	201k	195k	177k	-29,8%

Table 16. Population of oblast capitals and industrial cities in the Central Non-Black-Earth Ring (Region 16), 1991-2021.

Central Black-Earth Region

Across the fertile *Chernozemye* oblasts of Belgorod, Voronezh, Kursk, Lipetsk, Orel and Tambov (Region 17), repatriation inflows during the 1990s and the growth of Voronezh and Belgorod moderated overall regional decline to -9,4%, from 7,75M in 1991 to 7,02M in 2021 (Table 17) [9].

Settlement	Other Names	Coords	1991	2002	2010	2014	2021	Change
Voronezh	Voronezh Don Basin	51,66, 39,2 (Russia)	900k	849k	890k	1,01M	1,06M	+17,6%
Lipetsk	Lipetsk Metallurgical	52,61, 39,6 (Russia)	460k	506k	509k	510k	496k	+7,8%
Kursk	Kursk Seim Basin	51,73, 36,19 (Russia)	433k	412k	415k	431k	440k	+1,6%
Orel	Oryol	52,97, 36,06 (Russia)	345k	333k	318k	317k	303k	-12,2%
Belgorod	Belgorod Chernozem	50,6, 36,59 (Russia)	311k	337k	356k	379k	340k	+9,3%
Tambov	Tambov Tsna Basin	52,72, 41,45 (Russia)	311k	294k	280k	285k	262k	-15,8%
Stary Oskol	Oskol Metallurgical	51,3, 37,84 (Russia)	181k	216k	221k	221k	222k	+22,7%

Table 17. Population of Voronezh, Lipetsk, Belgorod and regional centres in the Central Black-Earth Belt (Region 17), 1991-2021.

Tatarstan and Bashkortostan

Supported by oil-refining, petrochemical industry and balanced natural and migratory trends, the republics of Tatarstan and Bashkortostan (Region 18) grew by +4,9% from 7,58M in 1991 to 7,95M in 2021, led by Kazan and Ufa (Table 18) [9].

Settlement	Other Names	Coords	1991	2002	2010	2014	2021	Change
Kazan	Qazan; Tatarstan Capital	55,8, 49,11 (Russia)	1,1M	1,1M	1,14M	1,19M	1,31M	+18,6%
Ufa	Bashkortostan Capital	54,74, 55,97 (Russia)	1,1M	1,04M	1,06M	1,1M	1,15M	+4,4%
Naberezhnye Chelny	Brezhnev; KAMAZ City	55,74, 52,4 (Russia)	512k	510k	513k	522k	548k	+7%
Sterlitamak	Sterlitamak Bashkortostan	53,63, 55,93 (Russia)	252k	264k	273k	277k	277k	+9,9%

Nizhnekamsk	Nizhnekamsk Petrochemical	55,64, 51,82 (Russia)	197k	226k	234k	235k	241k	+22,3%

Table 18. Population of Kazan, Ufa and industrial cities in Tatarstan and Bashkortostan (Region 18), 1991-2021.

Middle Volga and the Finno-Ugric Republics

Across Samara, Nizhny Novgorod, Kirov, Ulyanovsk and Penza oblasts alongside Chuvashia, Mari El, Mordovia and Udmurtia (Region 19), industrial restructuring and natural decrease reduced the regional population by -13,5%, from 15,4M in 1991 to 13,31M in 2021 (Table 19) [9].

Settlement	Other Names	Coords	1991	2002	2010	2014	2021	Change
Nizhny Novgorod	Gorky; Gorkiy	56,33, 44,01 (Russia)	1,45M	1,31M	1,25M	1,26M	1,23M	-15,2%
Samara	Kuybyshev	53,2, 50,1 (Russia)	1,25M	1,16M	1,17M	1,17M	1,17M	-6,3%
Tolyatti	Stavropol-on-Volga; AvtoVAZ City	53,51, 49,42 (Russia)	655k	703k	720k	718k	685k	+4,6%
Ulyanovsk	Simbirsk	54,31, 48,4 (Russia)	648k	636k	615k	617k	617k	-4,8%
Izhevsk	Ustinov; Udmurtia Capital	56,85, 53,21 (Russia)	647k	632k	628k	637k	623k	-3,7%
Penza	Penza Sura Basin	53,2, 45,02 (Russia)	546k	518k	517k	521k	501k	-8,2%
Kirov	Vyatka; Khlynov	58,6, 49,67 (Russia)	445k	458k	474k	487k	468k	+5,2%
Cheboksary	Shupashkar; Chuvashia Capital	56,15, 47,25 (Russia)	436k	441k	454k	469k	497k	+14%
Saransk	Mordovia Capital	54,19, 45,18 (Russia)	320k	305k	297k	299k	315k	-1,6%
Dzerzhinsk	Rastyapino	56,24, 43,46 (Russia)	286k	261k	241k	234k	219k	-23,4%
Yoshkar-Ola	Tsaryovo-kokshaysk; Mari El Capital	56,63, 47,9 (Russia)	249k	257k	249k	260k	281k	+12,9%

Table 19. Urban populations in the Middle Volga oblasts and Finno-Ugric republics (Region 19), 1991-2021.

Lower Volga and Kalmykia

Along the lower Volga valley in Saratov, Volgograd and Astrakhan oblasts and the Republic of Kalmykia (Region 20), early repatriation gains were followed by post-2000 natural decline, reducing the regional total by -9,6% from 7,12M in 1991 to 6,44M in 2021 (Table 20) [9].

Settlement	Other Names	Coords	1991	2002	2010	2014	2021	Change
Volgograd	Tsaritsyn; Stalingrad	48,71, 44,51 (Russia)	1,01M	1,01M	1,02M	1,02M	1,03M	+2,1%
Saratov	Saratov Lower Volga	51,53, 46,03 (Russia)	911k	873k	838k	841k	901k	-1,1%
Astrakhan	Xacitarxan; Itil Delta	46,35, 48,04 (Russia)	512k	505k	521k	531k	476k	-7%
Volzhsky	Volzhsky Hydro City	48,79, 44,78 (Russia)	278k	313k	314k	326k	321k	+15,5%
Balakovo	Balakovo Saratov Volga	52,03, 47,8 (Russia)	201k	200k	200k	195k	184k	-8,5%
Engels	Pokrovsk Lower Volga	51,48, 46,12 (Russia)	184k	194k	202k	218k	225k	+22,3%
Elista	Stepnoy; Kalmykia Capital	46,31, 44,26 (Russia)	93k	104k	104k	104k	103k	+10,8%

Table 20. Population of Volgograd, Saratov, Astrakhan and Elista in the Lower Volga region (Region 20), 1991-2021.

Kuban, Don and Stavropol

Attracting both post-Soviet repatriates and retirees from northern Russia, the Southern Russian Sunbelt of Krasnodar and Stavropol krais, Rostov Oblast and Adygea (Region 21) expanded by +11,9% from 13,15M in 1991 to 14,71M in 2021, with Krasnodar crossing the one-million threshold alongside booming Sochi and Stavropol (Table 21) [9].

Settlement	Other Names	Coords	1991	2002	2010	2014	2021	Change
Rostov-on-Don	Rostov-na-Donu	47,24, 39,7 (Russia)	1,03M	1,07M	1,09M	1,11M	1,14M	+11,1%
Krasnodar	Yekaterinodar	45,04, 38,98 (Russia)	631k	646k	745k	806k	1,1M	+74,2%
Sochi	Sochi Black Sea Resort	43,59, 39,72 (Russia)	344k	329k	343k	399k	466k	+35,5%
Stavropol	Voroshilovsk	45,04, 41,97 (Russia)	328k	355k	399k	420k	547k	+66,8%
Taganrog	Taganrog Azov Sea	47,24, 38,9 (Russia)	293k	282k	258k	254k	245k	-16,4%

Shakhty	Aleksandrovsk-Grushevsky	47,71, 40,21 (Russia)	227k	223k	240k	237k	226k	-0,4%
Novorossiysk	Sudzhuk-Kale	44,72, 37,77 (Russia)	189k	232k	242k	257k	262k	+38,6%
Novocher-kassk	Don Cossack Capital	47,42, 40,09 (Russia)	189k	171k	169k	173k	164k	-13,2%
Volgodonsk	Atommash City	47,51, 42,15 (Russia)	181k	166k	171k	170k	168k	-7,2%
Armavir	Armavir Kuban	44,99, 41,12 (Russia)	162k	194k	189k	192k	187k	+15,4%
Maykop	Myequape; Adygea Capital	44,61, 40,1 (Russia)	154k	157k	144k	145k	143k	-7,1%
Pyatigorsk	Caucasian Mineral Waters	44,05, 43,06 (Russia)	131k	141k	143k	146k	146k	+11,5%
Kislovodsk	Narzan Spa	43,91, 42,72 (Russia)	116k	130k	129k	130k	128k	+10,3%

Table 21. Population of Rostov-on-Don, Krasnodar, Sochi, Stavropol and sunbelt cities (Region 21), 1991-2021.

Chechnya and Ingushetia

Despite wartime devastation in Grozny during the Chechen Wars of 1994-2009 and the permanent departure of most ethnic Russian residents, high Vainakh natural increase and post-war reconstruction lifted Chechnya and Ingushetia (Region 22) by +54,5% from 1,32M in 1991 to 2,04M in 2021, while displaced arrivals swelled Nazran nearly sevenfold (Table 22) [9].

Settlement	Other Names	Coords	1991	2002	2010	2014	2021	Change
Grozny	Solzha-Gala; Chechnya Capital	43,32, 45,7 (Russia)	388k	211k	272k	280k	329k	-15,2%
Gudermes	Gümse; Gudermes Railway Junction	43,35, 46,1 (Russia)	39k	34k	46k	50k	64k	+64,1%
Urus-Martan	Urus-Martan Chechnya	43,13, 45,54 (Russia)	35k	40k	49k	54k	63k	+80%
Shali	Shali Chechnya	43,15, 45,9 (Russia)	26k	40k	48k	50k	55k	+111,5%

Nazran	Nazran Ingushetia IDP Hub	43,23, 44,76 (Russia)	19k	125k	93k	106k	122k	+542,1%

Table 22. Population of Grozny, Nazran and urban centres in Chechnya and Ingushetia (Region 22), 1991-2021.

North Ossetia, Kabardino-Balkaria and Karachay-Cherkessia

Across the central North Caucasus republics of North Ossetia-Alania, Kabardino-Balkaria and Karachay-Cherkessia (Region 23), indigenous natural increase and refugee inflows from South Ossetia outweighed ethnic Russian out-migration, lifting the regional total by +9,9% from 1,92M in 1991 to 2,11M in 2021 (Table 23) [9].

Settlement	Other Names	Coords	1991	2002	2010	2014	2021	Change
Vladikavkaz	Ordzhonikidze; Dzaudzhikau	43,03, 44,68 (Russia)	306k	316k	312k	307k	296k	-3,3%
Nalchik	Nalchik Kabardino-Balkaria	43,49, 43,61 (Russia)	240k	275k	240k	239k	247k	+2,9%
Cherkessk	Batalpashinsk	44,22, 42,06 (Russia)	115k	116k	129k	124k	113k	-1,7%
Prokhladny	Прохладный; Prokhladnaya	43,76, 44,03 (Russia)	58k	61,8k	59,6k	58,1k	59,9k	+3,3%
Beslan	Беслан; Prigorodny District	43,18, 44,53 (Russia)	33k	35,5k	36,7k	37k	35,9k	+8,9%

Table 23. Population of Vladikavkaz, Nalchik, Cherkessk and Beslan in the central North Caucasus (Region 23), 1991-2021.

Republic of Dagestan

Sustained natural increase and mountain-to-piedmont migration made Dagestan (Region 24) the fastest-growing region in the post-Soviet space, expanding by +77,1% from 1,88M in 1991 to 3,33M in 2021 and nearly doubling the population of Makhachkala, Kaspiysk and Khasavyurt (Table 24) [9].

Settlement	Other Names	Coords	1991	2002	2010	2014	2021	Change
Makhachkala	Petrovsk-Port; Anji	42,98, 47,5 (Russia)	332k	462k	572k	578k	623k	+87,7%

Derbent	Bab al-Abwab; Chora	42,06, 48,29 (Russia)	81k	101k	119k	120k	125k	+54,3%
Khasavyurt	Khasavyurt Dagestan	43,25, 46,59 (Russia)	74k	122k	131k	135k	155k	+109,5%
Kaspiysk	Dvigatelstroy	42,88, 47,64 (Russia)	62k	78k	100k	105k	121k	+95,2%

Table 24. Population of Makhachkala, Khasavyurt, Derbent and Kaspiysk in Dagestan (Region 24), 1991-2021.

Ural Industrial Belt

Across Sverdlovsk, Chelyabinsk, Perm, Orenburg and Kurgan oblasts (Region 25), the growth of Yekaterinburg and Chelyabinsk nearly offset steep contraction in single-industry metallurgical and mining towns such as Nizhny Tagil, Zlatoust and Berezniki, limiting overall regional decline to -3,8% (from 16,32M in 1991 to 15,7M in 2021; Table 25) [9].

Settlement	Other Names	Coords	1991	2002	2010	2014	2021	Change
Yekaterinburg	Sverdlovsk	56,84, 60,61 (Russia)	1,38M	1,29M	1,35M	1,41M	1,54M	+12,3%
Chelyabinsk	Tankograd	55,16, 61,44 (Russia)	1,15M	1,08M	1,13M	1,17M	1,19M	+3,7%
Perm	Molotov	58,01, 56,25 (Russia)	1,09M	1M	991k	1,03M	1,03M	-5,5%
Orenburg	Chkalov	51,77, 55,1 (Russia)	552k	549k	548k	560k	544k	-1,4%
Magnitogorsk	Magnitka	53,41, 58,98 (Russia)	444k	419k	408k	415k	411k	-7,4%
Nizhny Tagil	Tagil Ural Steel	57,91, 59,98 (Russia)	439k	390k	362k	357k	339k	-22,8%
Kurgan	Tsaryovo Gorodishche	55,44, 65,34 (Russia)	363k	346k	334k	326k	311k	-14,3%
Orsk	Orenburg Fortress	51,23, 58,48 (Russia)	273k	251k	239k	233k	189k	-30,8%
Zlatoust	Zlatoust South Urals	55,17, 59,65 (Russia)	208k	195k	175k	171k	162k	-22,1%

Berezniki	Berezniki Upper Kama	59,41, 56,82 (Russia)	201k	173k	157k	150k	138k	-31,3%

Table 25. Population of Yekaterinburg, Chelyabinsk, Perm and industrial centres in the Urals (Region 25), 1991-2021.

Yugra and Yamal

Unlike the depopulating coal and metal-mining zones of the Russian North, the oil and gas autonomous okrugs of Khanty-Mansi (Yugra) and Yamalo-Nenets (Region 26) expanded by +23,9% from 1,82M in 1991 to 2,25M in 2021, led by Surgut, Nizhnevartovsk, Novy Urengoy and Khanty-Mansiysk (Table 26) [9].

Settlement	Other Names	Coords	1991	2002	2010	2014	2021	Change
Surgut	Surgut Yugra Oil Core	61,25, 73,42 (Russia)	259k	285k	307k	332k	396k	+52,9%
Nizhnevar-tovsk	Samotlor Oil Capital	60,93, 76,55 (Russia)	247k	239k	252k	266k	283k	+14,6%
Novy Urengoy	Yamal Gas Capital	66,08, 76,63 (Russia)	95k	94k	104k	116k	107k	+12,6%
Noyabrsk	Ноябрьск; Yamalo-Nenets AO	63,2, 75,45 (Russia)	90k	96,4k	110,6k	107,4k	100,2k	+11,3%
Khanty-Mansiysk	Ostyako-Vogulsk; Samarovo	61, 69 (Russia)	35k	54k	80k	93k	107k	+205,7%
Salekhard	Салехард; Obdorsk	66,53, 66,6 (Russia)	32,3k	36,8k	42,5k	47,9k	47,9k	+48,3%

Table 26. Population of Surgut, Nizhnevartovsk, Novy Urengoy and administrative centres in Yugra and Yamal (Region 26), 1991-2021.

West Siberian Corridor

Along the West Siberian section of the Trans-Siberian Railway across Tyumen, Omsk, Novosibirsk and Tomsk oblasts and Altai Krai (Region 27), rapid growth in Tyumen, Novosibirsk and Tomsk cushioned rural and industrial losses elsewhere, holding overall contraction to -5,9% (from 11,15M in 1991 to 10,49M in 2021; Table 27) [9].

Settlement	Other Names	Coords	1991	2002	2010	2014	2021	Change
Novosibirsk	Novoniko-layevsk	55,01, 82,94 (Russia)	1,45M	1,43M	1,47M	1,55M	1,63M	+13%
Omsk	Omsk Irtysh	54,99, 73,32 (Russia)	1,17M	1,13M	1,15M	1,17M	1,13M	-3,5%
Barnaul	Barnaul Upper Ob	53,35, 83,78 (Russia)	607k	601k	612k	633k	631k	+4%
Tomsk	Tomsk University City	56,5, 84,97 (Russia)	506k	488k	525k	557k	556k	+9,9%
Tyumen	Chimgi-Tura	57,15, 65,53 (Russia)	491k	511k	582k	679k	847k	+72,5%
Biysk	Biysk Altai Gateway	52,54, 85,21 (Russia)	234k	219k	210k	204k	184k	-21,4%
Rubtsovsk	Rubtsovsk Altai Krai	51,5, 81,21 (Russia)	172k	163k	147k	147k	127k	-26,2%
Tobolsk	Historic Siberian Capital	58,2, 68,25 (Russia)	96k	93k	100k	98k	100k	+4,2%

Table 27. Population of Novosibirsk, Omsk, Tyumen, Barnaul and Tomsk in the West Siberian Corridor (Region 27), 1991-2021.

Kuzbass Coal Basin

Post-Soviet coal-mine closures and metallurgical restructuring across Kemerovo Oblast (Region 28) reduced the population of the Kuzbass by -18,2% from 3,18M in 1991 to 2,6M in 2021, with steep losses in Prokopyevsk and Kiselevsk alongside moderate contraction in Novokuznetsk and Kemerovo (Table 28) [9].

Settlement	Other Names	Coords	1991	2002	2010	2014	2021	Change
Novokuznetsk	Stalinsk; Kuznetsk	53,76, 87,12 (Russia)	602k	550k	548k	550k	537k	-10,8%
Kemerovo	Shcheglovsk	55,35, 86,09 (Russia)	521k	485k	533k	544k	553k	+6,1%
Prokopyevsk	Prokopyevsk Kuzbass Coal	53,91, 86,72 (Russia)	274k	225k	210k	201k	178k	-35%

Kiselevsk	Kiselevsk Kuzbass Coal	53,99, 86,64 (Russia)	128k	106k	98k	93k	83k	-35,2%

Table 28. Population of Novokuznetsk, Kemerovo, Prokopyevsk and Kiselevsk in the Kuzbass coal basin (Region 28), 1991-2021.

Altai, Khakassia and Tuva

In the southern Siberian republics of Altai, Khakassia and Tuva (Region 29), above-replacement Tuvan and Altai fertility offset ethnic Russian out-migration, keeping the regional population nearly unchanged at 1,08M in 2021 (-0,5% from 1,09M in 1991) while lifting Kyzyl, Abakan and Gorno-Altaysk (Table 29) [9].

Settlement	Other Names	Coords	1991	2002	2010	2014	2021	Change
Abakan	Ust-Abakanskoye; Khakassia Capital	53,72, 91,43 (Russia)	157k	165k	165k	173k	185k	+17,8%
Kyzyl	Belotsarsk; Khem-Beldyr	51,72, 94,44 (Russia)	87k	104k	110k	114k	125k	+43,7%
Chernogorsk	Черногорск; Khakassia	53,82, 91,28 (Russia)	80k	73,1k	72,1k	73,2k	75,7k	-5,3%
Gorno-Altaysk	Горно-Алтайск; Ulala	51,96, 85,96 (Russia)	46,9k	53,5k	56,9k	61,4k	65,3k	+39,3%

Table 29. Population of Abakan, Kyzyl, Chernogorsk and Gorno-Altaysk in southern Siberia (Region 29), 1991-2021.

East Siberian Corridor

Along the Angara-Yenisei industrial corridor in Krasnoyarsk Krai and Irkutsk Oblast (Region 30), the growth of Krasnoyarsk past one million inhabitants contrasted with contraction in timber and aluminium towns such as Bratsk and Angarsk, reducing the regional total by -14,3% from 6,03M in 1991 to 5,17M in 2021 (Table 30) [9].

Settlement	Other Names	Coords	1991	2002	2010	2014	2021	Change
Krasnoyarsk	Krasny Yar Yenisei	56,02, 92,89 (Russia)	924k	909k	974k	1,03M	1,19M	+28,6%
Irkutsk	Irkutsk Angara-Baikal	52,29, 104,31 (Russia)	639k	593k	588k	613k	617k	-3,4%

Angarsk	Angarsk Petrochemical	52,54, 103,89 (Russia)	269k	247k	234k	229k	221k	-17,8%
Bratsk	Bratsk Angara Hydro	56,15, 101,63 (Russia)	259k	259k	246k	239k	224k	-13,5%

Table 30. Population of Krasnoyarsk, Irkutsk, Angarsk and Bratsk in the East Siberian Corridor (Region 30), 1991-2021.

Norilsk, Taymyr and Evenkia

In the polar mining and timber district of Norilsk, Taymyr and Evenkia in northern Krasnoyarsk Krai (Region 31), the curtailment of northern labour subsidies reduced the regional population by -42,1%, from 380k in 1991 to 220k in 2021 (Table 31) [9].

Settlement	Other Names	Coords	1991	2002	2010	2014	2021	Change
Norilsk	Norilsk-Talnakh-Kayerkan	69,36, 88,19 (Russia)	265k	213k	175k	177k	175k	-34%
Dudinka	Дудинка; Taymyr Port	69,41, 86,18 (Russia)	32,1k	25,1k	22,2k	22k	19,6k	-39,1%
Igarka	Игарка; Turukhansky Krai	67,47, 86,58 (Russia)	18,8k	8,6k	6,2k	5,3k	3,6k	-80,7%
Tura	Тура; Evenkia Capital	64,28, 100,22 (Russia)	7,5k	5,8k	5,5k	5,5k	4,4k	-40,8%

Table 31. Population of Norilsk, Dudinka, Igarka and Tura in the Yenisei North (Region 31), 1991-2021.

Buryatia and Zabaykalsky Krai

Across Transbaikalia in the Republic of Buryatia and Zabaykalsky Krai (Region 32), rural-to-urban migration lifted Ulan-Ude by nearly a quarter even as westward out-migration reduced the overall regional population by -17,2%, from 2,41M in 1991 to 2M in 2021 (Table 32) [9].

Settlement	Other Names	Coords	1991	2002	2010	2014	2021	Change
Chita	Transbaikal Capital	52,03, 113,5 (Russia)	376k	317k	324k	336k	334k	-11,2%
Ulan-Ude	Verkhne-udinsk; Buryatia Capital	51,83, 107,58 (Russia)	366k	359k	404k	421k	438k	+19,7%

Krasnokamensk	Краснокаменск; Priargunsky Uranium Combine	50,1, 118,04 (Russia)	67k	55,9k	55,7k	54,3k	51,1k	-23,7%
Severobaykalsk	Северобайкальск; BAM Capital	55,64, 109,32 (Russia)	28,6k	25,4k	24,9k	24,1k	24,2k	-15,3%

Table 32. Population of Ulan-Ude, Chita, Krasnokamensk and Severobaykalsk in Transbaikalia (Region 32), 1991-2021.

Sakha Republic (Yakutia)

In the Sakha Republic (Region 33), the exodus of ethnic Russian workers from northern mining and Arctic port settlements such as Neryungri and Tiksi was largely counterbalanced by high rural Sakha fertility and migration into Yakutsk, which nearly doubled between 1991 and 2021 and held overall regional contraction to -11,3% (from 1,11M to 985k; Table 33) [9].

Settlement	Other Names	Coords	1991	2002	2010	2014	2021	Change
Yakutsk	Tuymaada; Sakha Capital	62,04, 129,68 (Russia)	193k	211k	270k	294k	355k	+83,9%
Neryungri	South Yakutia Coal Hub	56,66, 124,72 (Russia)	76k	66k	62k	58k	53k	-30,3%
Mirny	Mir Diamond Pipe City	62,54, 113,96 (Russia)	39k	40k	37k	35k	34k	-12,8%
Tiksi	Тикси; Arctic Lena Port	71,64, 128,87 (Russia)	11,6k	5,9k	5,1k	4,6k	4,2k	-64%

Table 33. Population of Yakutsk, Neryungri, Mirny and Tiksi in the Sakha Republic (Region 33), 1991-2021.

Magadan, Chukotka and Kamchatka

Across the northeast Arctic and sub-Arctic belt of Magadan Oblast, Chukotka Autonomous Okrug and Kamchatka Krai (Region 34), the post-Soviet northern exodus reduced the regional population by more than half (-52,9%, from 1,03M in 1991 to 485k in 2021) and left Kolyma mining settlements such as Kadykchan completely abandoned (Table 34) [9].

Settlement	Other Names	Coords	1991	2002	2010	2014	2021	Change
Petropav-lovsk-Kamchatsky	Avacha Bay Port	53,04, 158,66 (Russia)	273k	198k	180k	183k	165k	-39,6%
Magadan	Nagayevo Bay; Kolyma Gateway	59,57, 150,81 (Russia)	155k	99k	96k	94k	90k	-41,9%
Anadyr	Novo-Mariinsk; Chukotka Capital	64,73, 177,52 (Russia)	17k	11k	13k	14k	13k	-23,5%
Susuman	Susuman Upper Kolyma Gold	62,78, 148,15 (Russia)	17k	7,8k	5,8k	5,1k	4,3k	-74,7%
Kadykchan	Kadykchan Kolyma Coal Ghost Town	63,09, 147,06 (Russia)	10,3k	875	-	-	-	Aban-doned

Table 34. Population of Petropavlovsk-Kamchatsky, Magadan, Anadyr and Kolyma mining towns (Region 34), 1991-2021.

Southern Far East and the Pacific Littoral

Across Primorsky and Khabarovsk krais, Amur and Sakhalin oblasts and the Jewish Autonomous Oblast (Region 35), sustained westward out-migration reduced the regional population by -24,3% from 6,06M in 1991 to 4,58M in 2021, with Khabarovsk, Vladivostok, Blagoveshchensk and Yuzhno-Sakhalinsk holding steady while defence and port towns such as Komsomolsk-on-Amur and Nakhodka contracted (Table 35) [9].

Settlement	Other Names	Coords	1991	2002	2010	2014	2021	Change
Vladivostok	Pacific Fleet Port	43,12, 131,89 (Russia)	648k	595k	592k	603k	601k	-7,3%
Khabarovsk	Khabarovka Amur	48,48, 135,07 (Russia)	613k	583k	577k	601k	617k	+0,7%
Komsomolsk-on-Amur	Komsomolsk-na-Amure	50,55, 137,01 (Russia)	319k	281k	264k	255k	239k	-25,1%
Blagovesh-chensk	Ust-Zeysky; Amur Capital	50,29, 127,53 (Russia)	211k	219k	214k	220k	241k	+14,2%
Nakhodka	Nakhodka Pacific Port	42,82, 132,89 (Russia)	165k	149k	160k	156k	140k	-15,2%
Yuzhno-Sakhalinsk	Vladimirovka; Toyohara	46,96, 142,74 (Russia)	164k	175k	182k	193k	182k	+11%

Ussuriysk	Nikolsk-Ussuriysky; Voroshilov	43,8, 131,95 (Russia)	162k	158k	158k	167k	180k	+11,1%
Birobidzhan	Tikhonkaya; Jewish AO Capital	48,79, 132,92 (Russia)	86k	77k	75k	75k	70k	-18,6%

Table 35. Population of Vladivostok, Khabarovsk, Blagoveshchensk and Pacific littoral cities (Region 35), 1991-2021.

Appendix

Regional Gazetteer Summary

Table 36 summarises the number of urban settlements covered in each of the 35 regions and their combined urban population from 1991 to 2021. Across all 234 cities and towns, total urban population rose from 91,07M in 1991 to 96,49M in 2021 (+6%), reflecting demographic concentration into metropolitan agglomerations (Regions 1, 5, 12, 13, 18, 21, 24 and 26) even as rural districts, conflict zones (Regions 9, 10 and 22) and northern or coal-mining *monogoroda* (Regions 15, 28, 31, 34 and 35) contracted.

Region (Cities)	1991	2002	2010	2014	2021	Change
1. Minsk City & Minsk Oblast Metropolitan Magnet (4)	1,97M	2,08M	2,18M	2,27M	2,34M	+18,7%
2. Western Belarus: Brest & Grodno Oblasts (5)	933k	1M	1,03M	1,1M	1,1M	+17,7%
3. Eastern & Southeastern Belarus: Vitebsk, Mogilev & Gomel Oblasts (9)	1,92M	1,9M	1,89M	1,95M	1,89M	-1,4%
4. Western Ukraine (9)	2,23M	2,16M	2,17M	2,18M	2,18M	-2,2%
5. Kyiv City & Kyiv Metropolitan Oblast (5)	2,99M	2,97M	3,16M	3,25M	3,38M	+13%
6. Central & Northern Ukraine Depopulation Belt (14)	3,14M	3,04M	2,96M	2,94M	2,85M	-9,1%
7. Kharkiv, Dnipro-petrovsk & Zaporizhzhia Industrial East (11)	5,45M	4,93M	4,77M	4,71M	4,5M	-17,5%
8. Ukrainian Black Sea Littoral (3)	1,98M	1,87M	1,81M	1,81M	1,76M	-11,2%
9. Government-Controlled Donbas (8)	1,39M	1,28M	1,2M	1,17M	1,08M	-22,2%
10. Occupied Donbas / ORDLO (7)	2,75M	2,47M	2,3M	2,25M	2,13M	-22,6%
11. Crimea & Sevastopol (4)	1,01M	950k	930k	978k	1,15M	+14,3%

12. Moscow City & Moscow Oblast Post-Soviet Hyper-Centralisation Core (10)	10,24M	11,6M	12,99M	13,74M	15,33M	+49,7%
13. Saint Petersburg, Leningrad Oblast & Kaliningrad Exclave (3)	5,45M	5,1M	5,32M	5,59M	6,18M	+13,4%
14. Depopulating Northwest: Pskov, Novgorod, Vologda & Republic of Karelia (5)	1,31M	1,29M	1,3M	1,32M	1,27M	-3,3%
15. European Arctic Exodus Zone: Murmansk, Arkhan-gelsk, Komi & Nenets AO (8)	1,75M	1,42M	1,34M	1,32M	1,16M	-34,1%
16. Central Non-Black-Earth Mortality & Shrinkage Ring (11)	4,67M	4,37M	4,31M	4,33M	4,18M	-10,4%
17. Central Black-Earth Belt (7)	2,94M	2,95M	2,99M	3,16M	3,12M	+6,1%
18. Republics of Tatarstan & Bashkortostan (5)	3,16M	3,15M	3,23M	3,32M	3,52M	+11,3%
19. Middle Volga Oblasts (11)	6,93M	6,68M	6,61M	6,68M	6,61M	-4,7%
20. Lower Volga (7)	3,19M	3,2M	3,2M	3,23M	3,24M	+1,6%
21. Southern Russian Sunbelt Magnet (13)	3,97M	4,09M	4,26M	4,44M	4,92M	+23,9%
22. Chechnya & Ingushetia (5)	507k	450k	508k	540k	633k	+24,9%
23. North Ossetia (5)	752k	804,3k	777,3k	765,1k	751,9k	0%
24. Republic of Dagestan (4)	549k	763k	922k	938k	1,02M	+86,5%
25. Ural Industrial Belt (10)	6,1M	5,7M	5,69M	5,82M	5,86M	-3,9%
26. Khanty-Mansi (6)	758,3k	805,3k	896,2k	962,4k	1,04M	+37,3%
27. West Siberian Trans-Siberian Belt (8)	4,72M	4,64M	4,8M	5,03M	5,2M	+10,3%
28. Kuzbass Coal-Metallurgical Basin (4)	1,52M	1,37M	1,39M	1,39M	1,35M	-11,4%
29. Southern Siberian Republics: Altai, Khakassia & Tuva (4)	370,9k	395,6k	404,1k	421,6k	451,1k	+21,6%
30. East Siberian Trans-Siberian & Angara-Yenisei Corridor (4)	2,09M	2,01M	2,04M	2,12M	2,25M	+7,6%

31. Norilsk, Taymyr & Evenkia Polar De-Population Zone (4)	323,4k	252,6k	208,9k	209,8k	202,6k	-37,3%
32. Republic of Buryatia (4)	837,6k	757,4k	808,6k	835,4k	847,4k	+1,2%
33. Sakha Republic (4)	319,6k	322,9k	374,1k	391,6k	446,2k	+39,6%
34. Extreme Northeast Arctic Exodus Zone (5)	472,3k	316,7k	294,8k	296,1k	272,3k	-42,3%
35. Southern Far East & Pacific Corridor (8)	2,37M	2,24M	2,22M	2,27M	2,27M	-4,1%
Total Gazetteer Sample (234)	91,07M	89,29M	91,3M	93,74M	96,49M	+6%

Table 36. Combined urban population across all 234 catalogued settlements by region from 1991 to 2021.

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